

Health and Social Care Scrutiny Commission

Tuesday 27 January 2026
7.00 pm
160, Tooley Street, SE1 2QH

Supplemental Agenda

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4.	Minutes The Minutes of the meeting held on 1 December 2025 are enclosed.	1 - 11
5.	Menopause A presentation will be given by: Mr Haitham Hamoda MD FRCOG, Consultant Gynaecologist, Subspecialist in Reproductive Medicine and Surgery, Clinical Lead Menopause Service, King's College Hospital Honorary Senior Lecturer King's College London Trustee and Past Chair British Menopause Society Bethan Jones will present the enclosed on menopause and local practice.	12 - 18
7.	Access to Toilets - update The commission will receive an update on a previous scrutiny review report making recommendation to improve Access to Toilets. A report is enclosed that will be presented by the below officers: • Tara Quinn, Head of Parks and Leisure • Environment,	19 - 31

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Webpage:

Date:

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HEALTH AND SOCIAL CARE SCRUTINY COMMISSION

MINUTES of the Health and Social Care Scrutiny Commission held on Monday 1 December 2025 at 7.00 pm at 160, Tooley Street, SE1 2QH

PRESENT: Councillor Suzanne Abachor (Chair)
Councillor Maria Linforth-Hall (Vice-Chair)
Councillor Esme Dobson
Councillor Sandra Rhule
Councillor Charlie Smith
Councillor Naima Ali

**OTHER MEMBERS
PRESENT:**

**OFFICER
SUPPORT:** Pauline O'Hare, Director of Adult Social Care

David Bass, Highways Technician

David Sole, Parking Services and Development Manager

John Wade, Head of Parking Services and Network Management

Michelle Peake, Head of Specialist Services

Julie Timbrell, Project Manager , scrutiny

1. APOLOGIES

Councillor Charlie Smith gave apologies for lateness.

2. NOTIFICATION OF ANY ITEMS OF BUSINESS WHICH THE CHAIR DEEMS URGENT

There were none.

3. DISCLOSURE OF INTERESTS AND DISPENSATIONS

There were none.

4. MINUTES

The minutes of the meeting held on 16 October were agreed as an accurate record.

5. HOARDING REPORT

The **Chair** introduced the item, advising that a presentation on hoarding in Southwark had been provided as evidence to support the Health and Social Care Scrutiny Commission's review of safeguarding.

The Chair invited **Pauline O'Hare , Director of Adult Social Care,** to introduce herself and present the report.

Presentation Summary

The Director of Adult Social Care delivered a presentation on hoarding in Southwark, setting out the nature of hoarding behaviour, its impact on individuals and communities, and the Council's multi-agency approach to prevention, risk management and safeguarding.

Members were informed that hoarding disorder is characterised by a persistent difficulty discarding possessions, regardless of their value, and is often accompanied by significant distress. Hoarding may exist as a condition in its own right or alongside other physical

or mental health conditions, including dementia, depression, substance misuse, schizophrenia, bipolar disorder, learning disability and obsessive-compulsive disorder. It was emphasised that hoarding can affect individuals of all ages and backgrounds and does not always indicate a lack of mental capacity.

The presentation outlined different forms of hoarding, including inanimate object hoarding, animal hoarding, data hoarding and financial hoarding. Officers described common characteristics, such as anxiety, excessive emotional attachment to possessions, difficulty making decisions, social isolation and limited insight into risk. Reference was also made to Diogenes Syndrome, a severe form of domestic squalor associated with extreme self-neglect, which may be primary in nature or secondary to other mental health conditions.

The legal framework for intervention was explained. Members were advised that hoarding is recognised under the **Care Act 2014** as a form of self-neglect and may therefore give rise to safeguarding duties where an individual has care and support needs and is unable to protect themselves from harm. The **Mental Capacity Act 2005** was highlighted as relevant when assessing an individual's ability to understand and weigh the risks associated with hoarding behaviour.

Members were informed about the **Southwark Hoarding Panel**, which meets every six weeks and brings together Adult Social Care, Housing, Children's Services, South London and Maudsley NHS Foundation Trust (SLaM), the London Fire Brigade and other partners. The panel reviews live cases and supports officers through a long-term, trauma-informed and multi-agency approach, recognising that sustainable change often requires ongoing engagement.

Data presented suggested that between 3,000 and 6,000 residents in Southwark may be affected by hoarding, although only a small proportion are likely to seek specialist support. Panel data showed a gradual increase in known cases among council tenants over recent years. Officers emphasised that without assessment and sustained

intervention, long-term improvement is unlikely.

The presentation also outlined the roles of key partners. Adult Social Care can provide support where Care Act eligibility is met; Environmental Health and Housing can intervene where conditions pose risks to health or safety; the London Fire Brigade carries out home fire safety visits; and health services, including SLAM, have responsibilities to assess and treat hoarding as a recognised mental health condition. The importance of training, trauma-informed practice and coordinated working across agencies was emphasised throughout.

Questions and Discussion

Members raised a number of questions following the presentation.

- **Ongoing support and mental health treatment**
A member asked whether individuals who hoard and have mental health conditions continue to receive support once treatment has ended. Officers advised that this depends on the severity of the hoarding behaviour and the individual's willingness to engage. Once immediate risks have been addressed, if an individual does not wish to continue to engage with services, ongoing support may not always be possible.
- **Balancing individual rights and wider impacts**
Members commented on the tension between respecting an individual's rights and protecting the safety and wellbeing of family members and neighbours. Officers explained that where a person has eligible needs under the Care Act, support such as deep or "blitz" cleans may be offered to enable care delivery or to maintain safe access within a property. However, it was stressed that blitz cleans can be traumatising and may worsen hoarding behaviour, and that trauma-informed practice is therefore prioritised.

- **Consistency between policy and practice**

A Councillor raised concerns that, in her experience, cases were not always handled in line with the practices described. She referred to a constituent living in extreme clutter and unsanitary conditions that had been described as a “lifestyle choice” by an Occupational Therapist. Officers agreed that hoarding should not be characterised as a lifestyle choice and stated that it is more commonly linked to trauma experienced in childhood or adolescence. The Member said in this case it had taken approximately two years to secure care support. Officers noted that while they could not comment on individual cases, engagement can take a significant amount of time and often requires a trigger for intervention, such as vermin, a fall or other serious risk. Members asked whether training was mandatory; officers advised that training was not mandatory but that extensive training opportunities were available.

- **Housing enforcement and eviction risk**

Members raised concerns that threats of eviction can exacerbate hoarding behaviour. Officers responded that Housing services sometimes need to act where there are serious risks, such as fire hazards or infestations, and that intervention may be necessary for the greater good. It was suggested that a combination of incentives and enforcement can sometimes be effective. A Councillor described a further case in which the housing officer appeared insufficiently informed about addiction issues and suggested that additional training was needed. Officers agreed that further training would be beneficial.

- **Hoarding in social housing**

Members asked how hoarding is addressed within social housing. Officers explained that there may be less need for intervention in certain situations, for example in semi-detached properties, but that referrals are frequently made by family members or neighbours. Where concerns relate only to clutter or mess, or a lot of possessions, officers may advocate for an individual’s right to hoard. However,

where conditions become unsanitary or impact neighbouring properties, intervention would be required.

- **Referrals and specialist support**

Officers confirmed that referrals are received from Housing Associations and that support may include blitz cleans and the involvement of specialist external agencies. Engagement was described as highly sensitive, requiring careful exploration of an individual's experiences and emotions, similar specialist support provided in the TV programme *The Hoarder Next Door*. Officers noted that cases involving unsanitary conditions are often the most challenging.

- **Early intervention and outcomes**

A member described a case involving a hoarder with care needs who eventually received effective support and subsequently experienced improved stability and reduced hospital admissions. The Member noted that health professionals had visited the property for a prolonged period before action was taken and suggested that intervention could have occurred earlier. She also highlighted that successful intervention had generated cost savings for health and care services. Officers acknowledged the importance of earlier intervention where possible.

Conclusion

The Commission noted the presentation and the discussion. Members highlighted the importance of consistent application of guidance, trauma-informed practice, earlier intervention, and appropriate training for frontline staff, and recognised hoarding as a complex safeguarding issue requiring sustained, multi-agency working.

6. BLUE BADGE SCHEME

The following officers introduced themselves and contributed to the discussion:

- **David Bass**, Highways Technician
- **David Sole**, Parking Services and Development Manager
- **John Wade**, Head of Parking Services and Network Management
- **Michelle Peake**, Head of Specialist Services

The chair invited the officers to provide a verbal summary of the report:

Officers summarised the actions taken in response to the Commission's earlier recommendations, including improvements to website information, an overview of Blue Badge fraud activity and enforcement, clarification of the differences between Blue Badges , Disabled Resident's Permit, AD permits and Streetscape permits and an outline of the current process and timescales for providing these. Officers also highlighted ongoing work to review systems and processes in order to improve integration and the resident experience.

The chair invited questions and the following points were made:

Linking AD Permits, Streetscape , Disabled Resident's Permits

A member asked whether it would be possible to link the disabled resident permit application process so that an AD permit and Streetscape permits could be issued automatically. Officers explained that work was underway to explore better integration of systems but noted that different permits operate under separate frameworks and system constraints, which would need to be addressed.

Communication and clarity between AD permits and Blue Badges

A member highlighted confusion arising from the similar appearance of renewal emails relating to AD permits and Blue Badges, which can cause misunderstanding for residents. Officers undertook to review this issue.

Display notices for legitimate Blue Badge use

A member suggested reintroducing a notice for display in vehicles to show legitimate ownership of a Blue Badge, noting that this had previously been provided before being discontinued during the Covid-19 pandemic. Officers confirmed that such notices had been provided historically but advised that there would be a cost implication. Officers also noted that there had been no recent requests for this feature and that any reintroduction would need to be weighed against efficiency and value for money considerations. Members commented that Blue Badges had become increasingly valuable, which is why the AD permit system had been introduced

i.e. in order to reduce the theft of Blue Badges. However, the lack of any notice on display in a vehicle means that other road users cannot recognise that the driver is a Blue Badge holder. This results in other road users thinking that a Blue Badge holder is eg illegally parking on double yellow lines when they are not, and other Blue Badges holders mistakenly thinking that a non-disabled driver is parked in a disabled bay when in fact they are a Blue Badge holder. The reintroduction of the paper scheme could eliminate such tensions between road users.

London-wide approach to AD permits

A member asked whether it would be possible to introduce a London-wide scheme for AD permits. Officers agreed to raise the issue through London Councils, while noting that approaches differ across boroughs. It was explained that Southwark operates the national scheme, whereas other boroughs offer additional local allowances.

Deterrence of Blue Badge fraud

In response to a question about deterring fraud, officers commented that ongoing enforcement action acts as a deterrent. Michelle Peake added that a public awareness campaign was being considered. Officers advised that the most common causes of fraud were stolen badges and, less frequently, use of badges belonging to deceased individuals.

Motability vehicles and enforcement correspondence

A member raised concerns about cases involving Motability vehicles, where traffic enforcement notices are issued to the disabled person as the registered keeper, and difficulties arise when carers attempt to resolve matters on the resident's behalf. Officers stated that, in such cases, they would be willing to discuss matters with an appropriate third party. The member described a long-running case in which increasingly threatening letters had been sent to a young man who is non-verbal, cannot write and cannot drive but he was the registered owner of the vehicle. She noted that a key issue was that membership of the mobility scheme is not always apparent, and officers agree this was a difficulty. The member asked for clarification as to why the parking department needed the resident to prove that they were disabled when ownership of a Motability vehicle de facto means that the resident is disabled. Officers explained that they do not have access to this information on their records.

Training for officers was suggested, and officers agreed that additional training would be beneficial.

RESOLVED

Officers will be asked to provide follow up on :

- An update on improving communication to residents to avoid confusion regarding the Blue Badge and AD Permit application process.
- Discussions with London Councils on developing an integrated AD Permit scheme
- A consideration of the request to reintroduce a display notice to indicate to the public that an AD Permit means the resident has legitimate right to disabled parking and Blue Badge
- An update on training to resolve potential communication problems between Motability residents / carers and the Council

7. SCRUTINY REVIEW : CANCER PREVENTION AND EARLY DIAGNOSIS

The commission discussed the headline report, and the following points were made:

- Prostate cancer rates are high, particularly amongst the black community. There is presently more publicity about this but this could be magnified even more. There has been a recent debate about a national screening programme but this has not been agreed, however there is definitely a case for more awareness and education around the non-invasive blood tests that can be carried out.
- A member spoke about the difficulties of getting an early diagnosis for blood cancer and spoke about a case where various opportunities were missed.

RESOLVED

- More information will be requested on blood cancer early diagnosis rates and more evidence on good practice from specialist charities sourced.
- The recommendation on the proposed self-sampling kits and language-specific information packs for women with FGM will be removed as members did not think this would work as the

trauma of FGM often causes physical and psychological scars, including bodily alienation, which would make self-sampling difficult.

- The recommendation on more work to prevent cancer will be strengthened.

8. HEALTHWATCH SOUTHWARK

The Healthwatch Southwark's Annual Report 2024-25, alongside a report setting out priorities for 2025-26, was noted.

Members asked about the future of Southwark Healthwatch given recent government announcements .

The scrutiny project manager conveyed an update from Healthwatch Southwark, who advised that they are:

- asking for support in signing this national petition: <https://petition.parliament.uk/petitions/732993>
- asking for support in terms of people reaching out directly to their MPs, to reflect the need for our services.
- provided a webpage of information about what Southwark Healthwatch understand the changes to mean: <https://www.healthwatchsouthwark.org/future-healthwatch-southwark-what-you-need-know>
- are waiting for Department of Health and Social Care confirmation of future funding post this financial year, update expected in January or after the King's speech
- are trying to influence the DHSC's new Directorate of patient experience as a collaborative network: <https://www.kingsfund.org.uk/insight-and-analysis/projects/learning-from-healthwatch>

9. WORK PROGRAMME

The workplan was agreed with the addition of :

- Interview with the Cabinet Member for Health and Well-being
- GP Appointments – report back on engagement with local practices to improve access to timely appointments



Menopause in Southwark

Dr Beth Jones

GP, Blackfriars Medical Practice

LARC Lead, Southwark Council

Clinical Lead for Women's and Girls' Health, SEL ICB

National picture

Key findings

In England in 2023/24 there were 13 million HRT items prescribed. This was a 22% increase since 2022/23. The estimated number of identified patients increased by 12%, from 2.3 million in 2022/23 to 2.6 million in 2023/24.

The least deprived areas in England had more than twice as many identified patients receiving HRT prescribing compared to the most deprived areas.

NHS Hormone Replacement Therapy Prescription Prepayment Certificate (HRT PPC)

If you pay for NHS prescribed HRT medicine 3 or more times in 12 months, an HRT PPC could save you money.

Each item on an NHS prescription usually costs £9.90. You can buy an HRT PPC for a one-off payment of £19.80 (the cost of two single items).

Major NHS update brings menopause into routine health checks

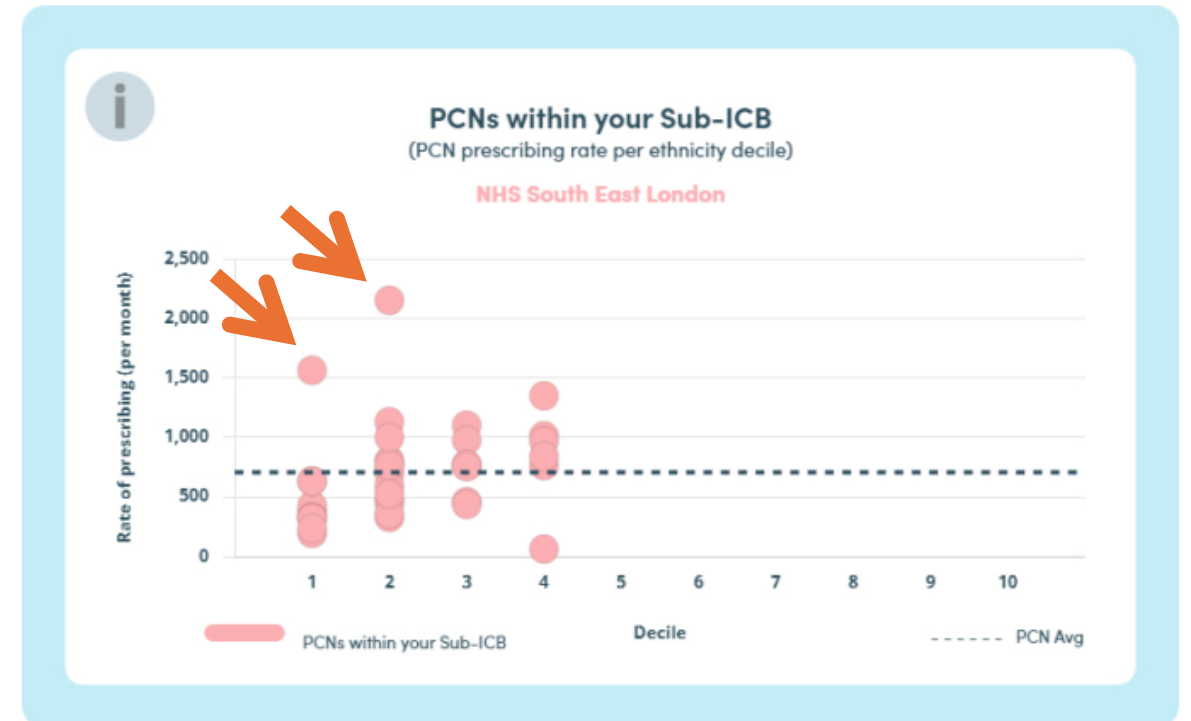
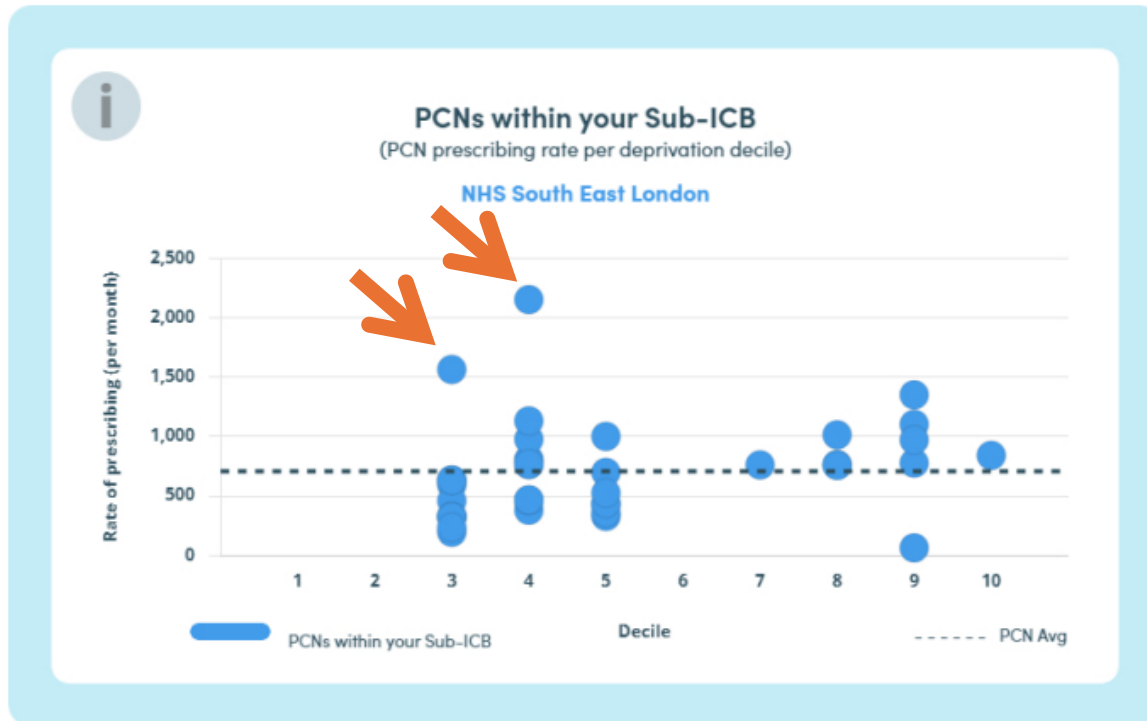
Menopause advice will be added to free health checks to help millions of women get the care they need.

Menopause and prostate problems will be among the priorities for the NHS's revolutionary new online hospital when it launches next year.

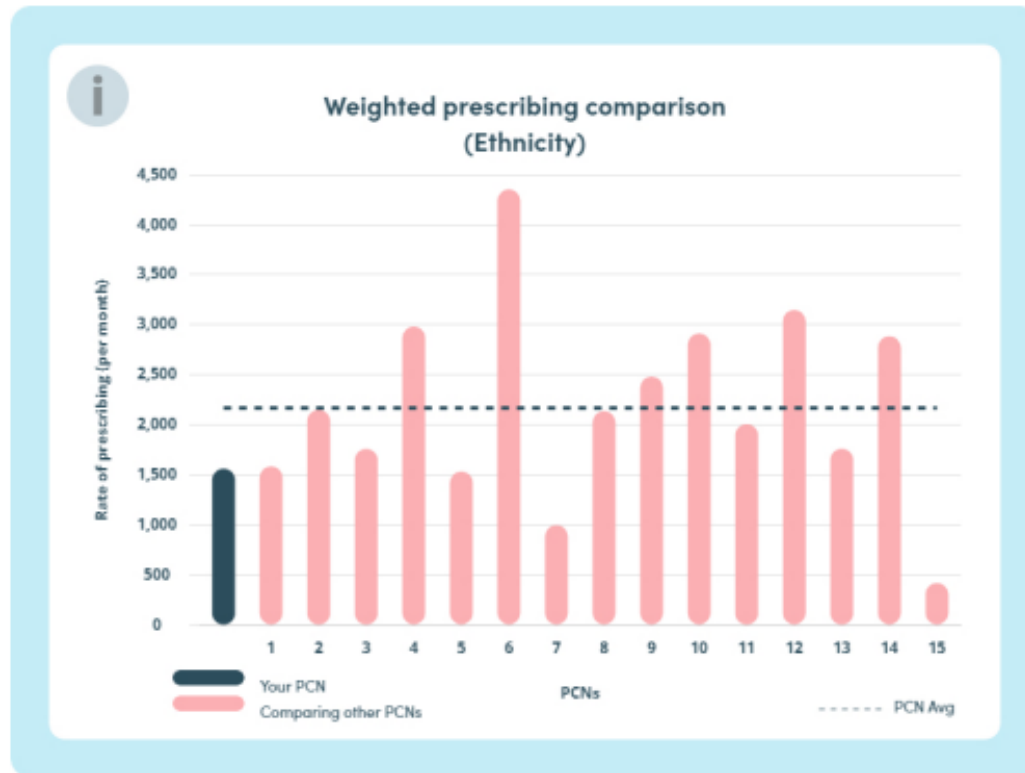
The NHS has selected nine common conditions which will be the first to be treated by the NHS Online service, providing faster access to specialist care.

Local picture

- North Southwark – 21,615 women aged 45-64
- South Southwark – 19,025 women aged 45-64



Compared to similar PCNs across England...



There was 262 appointments undertaken in Qtr 3 of 2025/26 for Menopause (MNP), This was made up of 245 unique women.

The GP Registered Borough this Quarter with the most appointments for HMB was Southwark with 262 appointments.

The ethnic group this quarter with the most appointments for HMB was White and the lowest appointments was Unknown.

Distinct Appointments per Month



Distinct Women Attending per Month

Financial Year	2024/25					2025/26								
Financial Quarter	Qtr 3		Qtr 4			Qtr 1			Qtr 2		Qtr 3			
GP Registered Borough	08-Nov	09-Dec	10-Jan	11-Feb	12-Mar	01-Apr	02-May	03-Jun	04-Jul	05-Aug	06-Sep	07-Oct	08-Nov	09-Dec
Bexley	38	20	20	22	19	19	32	20	32	22	36	23	26	22
Bromley	65	45	63	84	64	68	70	61	74	73	86	89	87	68
Greenwich	42	29	45	31	54	30	37	47	52	46	55	47	53	41
Lambeth	80	67	61	80	86	69	77	83	91	70	102	97	106	73
Lewisham	74	48	74	68	79	83	73	87	87	75	92	83	105	73
Southwark	95	58	90	49	82	91	84	97	113	94	110	89	82	74
Total	394	267	353	334	384	360	373	395	449	380	481	428	459	351

Broad Age Group

Ethnic Broad Group

IMD Quintile

Distinct Women Attending per Month by IMD Quintile for Procedure Type

Financial Year	2024/25						2025/26								
Financial Quarter	Qtr 3			Qtr 4			Qtr 1			Qtr 2			Qtr 3		
IMD Quintile	07-Oct	08-Nov	09-Dec	10-Jan	11-Feb	12-Mar	01-Apr	02-May	03-Jun	04-Jul	05-Aug	06-Sep	07-Oct	08-Nov	09-Dec
01 - 0-20%	20	14	9	10	9	14	17	21	22	21	18	10	15	15	
02 - 20-40%	35	23	36	23	35	31	31	40	51	40	45	43	27	28	
03 - 40-60%	26	14	30	12	30	33	25	25	29	27	32	27	19	25	
04 - 60-80%	11	*	9	*	7	11	10	8	9	5	12	7	16	*	
05 - 80-100%	*	*	*	*	*	*	*	*	*	*	*	*	*	*	
Non SEL Resident	*		*			*			*	*	*		*		
Total	95	58	90	49	82	91	84	97	113	94	110	89	82	74	

Local resources for clinicians

Training

- 'SEL primary care menopause course' - Feb 2026
- 'Pessary fitting and prolapse management' - Jan/Feb/March 2026
- 'Lifestyle medicine and menopause' and 'How to have sensitive conversations around women's health' – on demand

Other resources

- SEL Women's and Girls' Health Network – 2-monthly
- SEL Business Intelligence Dashboard – coming soon

Questions/discussion



Briefing: Public toilets - Action Plan Update

Health and Social Care Scrutiny Commission

27th January 2026

Background

This report provides an update on the work the council is doing to improve public toilet provision in Southwark. In October 2024 a cabinet report was presented in response to the review of public toilet provision in Southwark carried out by the Health and Social Care Scrutiny Commission. Nine recommendations were made aimed addressing gaps in toilet provision, especially for vulnerable groups. The recommendations impact multiple council departments and require a coordinated response. The paper below sets out the ongoing cross departmental work.

Update

The management and development of council managed public toilet facilities across the borough is carried out by several different council departments. Officers from 10 different teams have been brought together to form a public toilet working group. The group meet once a quarter and membership also includes a resident of southwark who is involved in the campaign for improved public toilet provision.

The aims of the group are to;

- Deliver and develop the actions in the Toilet Action Plan (see appendix 1)
- Improve the standards of provision of the council's existing public toilets (See appendix 2)
- Work with businesses and the wider community to improve the number of public toilets available
- Improve communications to inform residents and visitors where they can find a public toilet
- Where possible/feasible provide additional public toilets particularly in areas of low provision

Table 1 - Role and Responsibilities of teams who form the Toilet Working Group

Team	Role
Parks and Natural Environment Team	day-to-day operations of public toilets across parks and open spaces.
Asset Management	day to day operations of public toilets in Council office buildings such as Tooley St and Queens Road
Leisure Centres Team	day-to-day operations of public toilets across leisure centres
Culture Team	day-to-day operations of public toilets across libraries
Local Economy Team	responsible for engagement with local businesses
Comms Team	development and delivery of the communications plan
Consultation and involvement Team	linking the working group and the Toilet Action plan to stakeholder groups
Sustainable Growth	allocation of CiL and S106 funding which can be used for public toilet improvements
Community Safety	raising awareness and reducing anti social behaviour in public toilets
Public Health Team	providing insight on the needs and requirements of target groups

Annual review – a consistent approach

Through working collaboratively, the group also contribute to an annual programme of work to ensure that the data and information that the council shares is current and up to date and that the Toilet Action Plan continues to evolve.

Table 2 - programme of data checks and communications

Action	Purpose	Time frame
Working Group membership	Update the membership of the working group to ensure the right officers are included, send out diary invites	Annually (Apr)
Data refresh	Update the council's public toilet data spreadsheet to ensure all of the information is correct	Annually (Apr)
Toilet Map update	Once the data has been checked then any changes are to be updated on the toilet map online	Annually (Apr)
Google maps update	Update where possible information regarding the council's public toilets on Google Maps	Annually (Apr)
Web check	Council 'Public Toilet' web page is checked for accuracy and that links still work	Annually (Apr)
Comms refresh	Re distribution of comms materials and reposting of social media, parks to check notice boards etc.	Bi Annually (May & Nov)
Call to action for local businesses	In addition to the ongoing work by Local Town Centre Team, a call to action to be included in the e-newsletter to businesses	Annually

Investment

In addition to the ongoing delivery of the Toilet Action plan, officers across a number of teams have been working on various investment projects to either improve existing council public toilets or deliver new ones. Below are the projects that have either been delivered or are in the process of being delivered.

Existing - Peckham Rye Park - Peckham Rye Park's existing public toilet block is to be refurbished this spring, delivering a safe, inclusive and durable amenity for park visitors. Estimated to open in April 2026.

The current facilities have not been refurbished for many years and have been subject to numerous arson attacks and antisocial behaviour incidents. The equipment and finishes are now damaged beyond repair and deep clean. The layout is restrictive and unwelcoming.

The objective of the refurbishment is to provide good quarterly facilities that require low maintenance, have strong anti-vandal fixtures and facilities. Once the project has been completed the toilets will reopen from 7.30-21.00 in the summer and to dusk in the winter. They will be subject to a daily cleaning regime operated through the Corporate Facilities Maintenance Contract.

Existing - East Street Market toilets – Officers are currently exploring a refurbishment project to improve the public toilets in the busy East Street market. The facilities are dated and subject to incidents of anti social behaviour. Plans and costs have been developed and officers are currently exploring opportunities for funding.

Existing – Dulwich Library – The refurbishment of Dulwich library is currently underway and due for completion in July 2026. Part of the project is the refurbishment of the ground floor public toilets (including 1 accessible toilet); however, there will also be an additional toilet installed on the first floor.

New provision - Brandon Library – As part of the refurbishment of the Brandon Estate Library is the provision of a new accessible public toilet. Works on the library are due to begin in February and will be completed in the summer.

New provision - Canada Water Leisure Centre - The council's new leisure centre opened in autumn last year. The facility includes a fully accessible new public toilet in the reception area, before the barriers to enter the facility. In addition to this, the centre also provides a Changing Places toilet which, whilst located within the centre, is open for use by anyone needing to use the changing places toilet.

Officers across the council continue to explore the potential for the provision of new public toilets where feasible and sustainable, particularly in relation to the development of new public building and facilities.

Challenges

The OSC report also made the recommendation to revive the council's Community Toilet Scheme. Unfortunately, the position on this remains the same, which is that while much work is underway, with toilet information consolidated on the Great British Toilet Map and engagement with businesses ongoing, there is currently no budget for a more formal scheme with businesses. Benchmarking of the scheme in other areas shows that, success requires a need for monitoring and financial incentives for business to cover costs.

The report also recommended the development of a comprehensive strategy through stakeholder engagement and mapping and the response was to commit to delivering an Accessible Toilet Plan that will ensure fair access, up-to-date information, and business engagement.

Despite the resource challenges, there has been progress on the council's work to improving public toilet provision. This includes:

1. A more coordinated and collaborative cross departmental approach to the council's work on improving public toilet provision.
2. Completion of a number of capital investment schemes to improve provision of public toilets - with more to follow.
3. Consolidation of data on public toilets and updating of the information on the Toilet Map online.
4. The imminent delivery of a new council campaign, signposting residents on how they can find out where their nearest public toilet is, should they need one.
5. A refreshed focus on working with local business to encourage them to provide public access to their customer toilets.

Appendix 1. Toilet Action Plan

LBS Public Toilet Action Plan				
Action	Lead	Status	Comments	Next steps
1. Governance				
1.A) Develop an Accessible Toilet Plan to improve and ensure fair access to toilet facilities across the borough.	Tara Quinn	Completed	This document is the councils Toilet Access Plan. Reviewed quarterly at the toilet working group meeting. It is a working and dynamic document	Next review 26 Jan 2026 at quarterly Toilet Working Group meeting
1.B) Report on the progress of the Accessible Toilet Plan to the Health and Social Care Scrutiny Commission	Tara Quinn	In progress	Report back on progress with delivering recommendations - scheduled for Jan 2026 - slightly delayed due to resourcing challenges	Feedback to the Toilet Working group outcomes and any actions from Scrutiny meeting. Incorporate any actions into action plan
1.C) Set up Toilet Working Group	Tara Quinn	Completed	Meets Quarterly to: Oversee the development and delivery of the Toilet Action Plan Improve standards of provision and communications Report on issues with provision Update on opportunities for further funding and investment Update on capital investment projects Ensure that the provision of public toilets is considered as part	Next meeting 26 Jan 2026

			of resident focused services delivery	
2. Existing Council provision:				
2.A) Ensure adequate access to toilets in council offices, libraries, leisure centres, parks, and sports grounds.	Teams - Leisure Centres, Libraries, Corp Facility Management, Parks, Outdoor Recreation	Ongoing	Responsible for monitoring and improving the cleaning and maintenance of the public toilets in their service areas Responsible for ensuring staff permit access to toilets that are behind access barriers where necessary (leisure centres that don't have a pre barrier public toilet) Responsible for assisting with the annual update of maps, online info and comms.	Prepare for annual update process Parks Team - Look into incorporating FixMyStreet into comms messages to improve public reporting on toilet cleanliness/maintenance.
2.B) Consider increasing the frequency of cleaning library toilets, subject to resource implications.	Libraries, Corp Facility Management	Completed	Toilets deep cleaned and ongoing cleaning frequency is adequate. Monitoring is in place.	Review in April 2026
3. Mapping				

3.A) Create database of Council's public toilets	Project Officer	Completed	Have a single point of information on info about council provided public toilets, updated annually for accuracy, location, opening hours and facilities etc.	Next update due April 2026
3.B) Update the 'Toilet Map' to ensure locations and info are correct	Project Officer	Completed	Ensure that the location of council provided toilets on the 'toilet map' are correct and accurate and then reviewed annually	Next update due April 2026
3.C) Update google maps on locations and info about council provided public toilets	Project officers/comms/IT	Ongoing	Ensure that the location of council provided toilets on 'google maps' are correct and accurate and then reviewed annually.	Next update due April 2026
3.D) Undertake a gap analysis to identify toilet provision cold spots	Project Officer	In progress	This could only be completed once the data had been cleaned. then a gap analysis to be completed in order to find toilet cold spots in the borough. Accurate position is now known and gap analysis to be completed subject to resource	
4. Comms:				
4.A) Publicise the Great British Toilet Map on the council's website to provide information on accessible toilet locations.	Project Officer	Completed	The Toilet Map link is updated on council website. The website page has been updated to inform people where to find public toilets but also to encourage local businesses to open up their	Next review - April 2026

			customers toilets as public toilets	
4.B) Establish a full annually updated Comms Plan	Comms Team	In progress	Comms plan completed Southwark Public Toilet comms designs completed	Launch of new comms campaign in Spring 2026 Look into incorporating FixMyStreet into comms messages to improve public reporting on toilet cleanliness/maintenance. Next update of comms plan - Summer 2026 (incorporating learning and monitoring from Spring Campaign) Officers to carry out a review of street signage to identify gaps
4.C) Improve information - Signposting visitors of parks that do not have public toilets to the nearest public toilets	Parks Team	In progress	Parks officers are putting up information in 23 parks notice boards in parks/green spaces with no toilets making visitors aware of where the nearest council public toilet is. This will be completed by Feb 6th.	Review posters annually Check posters are still in parks public notice boards Check the information is correct
5. Business Engagement:				
5.A) Include the action to improve public toilet provision in Town Centre Action Plans	Local Economy Team	Completed		Review annually

5.B) Include a call for businesses to open up their customers toilets to the public in the Local Economy Team e-newsletter	Local Economy Team	Completed	Business e-newsletter sent to approx.12,000 Southwark businesses in May 2025. Aim is include the call to action in the e-newsletter 1-2 times a year.	Monitor update via the Toilet map and through feedback from businesses
5.C) Include action to improve access to public toilets in works plans of all town centre managers	Local Economy Team	In progress	Starting 1st April 2026 (building on previous work and conversations) Town centre managers to work together on how this can be approached	Review of progress in Oct 2026
5.D) Collaborate with key stakeholders like Age UK and local businesses/hospitals for the Accessible Toilet Plan.	All	Ongoing	Officers attended a workshop looking at Community Toilet Schemes in London in Oct 2025 and provided feedback to the Toilet Working Group Toilet Action Plan and Working Group has been linked in with the officers working on Southwark's Age friendly Borough Agenda and also Southwark Pensioners Action Group	Officers to follow up Asset Management leads in the NHS to explore opportunities for more public toilet provision and communication of public toilets by the NHS. Officers to continue seeking opportunities for partnership working, improving communication to target groups
6. Planning:				

6.A) Provide new public toilets as part of the new square at Peckham Rye Station.	Planning Team	Ongoing	Whilst the original (2016) planning consent for the Peckham Rye Station Square scheme included provision for public WCs, these were subsequently removed from the scope of the project due to land assembly, capital and revenue cost constraints and are no longer included within the scheme currently being delivered. However, public WCs are available in a number of other public buildings within the town centre including Peckham Pulse Leisure Centre, the Library and Peckham Levels. Further public WCs, including Changing Places-standard WCs, will also be delivered at Peckham Rye station as part of Network Rail's major station upgrade scheme which was subsequently granted planning consent in 2023, however timescale for delivery of this remains to be confirmed dependent upon full Government	Planning officers to keep the working group updated on the Network Rail Project
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			funding approval.	
6.B) Widen public access to toilet provision when undertaking works on existing or new buildings.	All	Ongoing	All officers to consider opportunities for the provision of new front facing public toilets when carrying out major works on council buildings. Good examples have been Canada Water Leisure Centre, Brandon library.	Working group to work with Sustainable Growth Team to identify future opportunities
7. Operational Challenges/ASB:				
7.A) Work with Community Safety Team to address any ASB issues in public toilets	Operational Teams and Community Safety Team	Ongoing	Operators to monitor antisocial behaviour and share information with wardens and safe neighbourhood teams. Park Liaison Officers now include the public toilets as part of	Officers to work with community safety on the recording of ASB that is specific to public toilets (non staffed)

			their patrol routes	
7.B) Publicise how visitors can report ASB in toilets that are not in staffed buildings	Operational Teams and Community Safety Team	Completed	Operational Teams to ensure new community safety posters are displayed in public toilets	Check every 6 months and refresh where necessary

Appendix 2. List of council managed public toilets

Area	Site	Facilities also include
Bankside and Walworth	Portland Street (East Street Market) Public Toilets	Disabled Toilet
Bankside and Walworth	Southwark Heritage Centre and Walworth Library	Disabled Toilet, Baby Changing
Bankside and Walworth	The Castle Leisure Centre	Disabled Toilet, Baby Changing, Changing Places
Bankside and Walworth	Tooley Street Offices	Disabled Toilet, Baby Changing
Bankside and Walworth	Una Marson Library	Disabled Toilet, Baby Changing
Bankside and Walworth	Geraldine Mary Harmsworth Centre	Disabled Toilet, Baby Changing
Bankside and Walworth	John Harvard Library	Disabled Toilet, Baby Changing
Bankside and Walworth	Burgess Chumleigh Gdns	Disabled Toilet, Baby Changing
Bankside and Walworth	Burgess Fishing Lake	Disabled Toilet, Baby Changing
Bankside and Walworth	Burgess Sports Centre	Disabled Toilet, Baby Changing
Bankside and Walworth	Burgess Tennis pavilion	Disabled Toilet, Baby Changing
Bermondsey and Rotherhithe	Blue Anchor Library	Disabled Toilet, Baby Changing
Bermondsey and Rotherhithe	Southwark Park	Disabled Toilet, Baby Changing
Bermondsey and Rotherhithe	Southwark Park Athletics Centre	Disabled Toilet, Baby Changing
Bermondsey and Rotherhithe	Surrey Docks Watersports Centre	Disabled Toilet, Baby Changing
Bermondsey and Rotherhithe	Canada Water Leisure Centre	Disabled Toilet, Baby Changing, changing places
Bermondsey and Rotherhithe	Canada Water Library	Disabled Toilet, Baby Changing, Changing Places
Camberwell and Dulwich	Belair Park Toilet	Disabled Toilet, Baby Changing
Camberwell and Dulwich	Camberwell Leisure Centre	Disabled Toilet, Baby Changing
Camberwell and Dulwich	Camberwell Library	Disabled Toilet, Baby Changing
Camberwell and Dulwich	Grove Vale Library	Disabled Toilet, Baby Changing
Camberwell and Dulwich	Kingswood Library	Disabled Toilet, Baby Changing
Camberwell and Dulwich	Dulwich Leisure Centre	Disabled Toilet, Baby Changing
Camberwell and Dulwich	Dulwich Library	Disabled Toilet, Baby Changing
Camberwell and Dulwich	Dulwich Park Bike Hire Toilet Block	Disabled Toilet
Camberwell and Dulwich	Dulwich Park Central Area Toilet Block	Disabled Toilet, Baby Changing
Camberwell and Dulwich	Dulwich Park Changing Places Toilet	Disabled Toilet, Baby Changing, Changing Places
Camberwell and Dulwich	Dulwich Park Francis Peek Community Centre	Disabled Toilet, Baby Changing
Peckham and Nunhead	Camberwell New Cemetery Columbarium	Disabled Toilet
Peckham and Nunhead	Camberwell Old Cemetery	Disabled Toilet
Peckham and Nunhead	Honor Oak Crematorium	Disabled Toilet, Baby Changing
Peckham and Nunhead	Nunhead Library	Disabled Toilet, Baby Changing
Peckham and Nunhead	Peckham Library	Disabled Toilet, Baby Changing
Peckham and Nunhead	Peckham Pulse Leisure Centre	Disabled Toilet, Baby Changing, Changing Places
Peckham and Nunhead	Peckham Rye Park	Disabled Toilet, Baby Changing
Peckham and Nunhead	Peckham Rye Park Nearest Playroom	Disabled Toilet, Baby Changing
Peckham and Nunhead	Queens Rd Peckham Offices	Disabled Toilet, Baby Changing

Item No. 8	Classification: Open	Date: 27 January 2026	Meeting Name: Health & Social Care Scrutiny Commission
Report title:		Health & Social Care Scrutiny Commission Work Programme 2025 - 26	
Ward(s) or groups affected:		N/a	
From:		Julie Timbrell, Project Manager, scrutiny.	

RECOMMENDATIONS

1. That the Health & Social Care Scrutiny Commission note the work programme as attached as Appendix 1 Work Plan, and review scope in appendix A.
2. That the Health & Social Care Scrutiny Commission consider the addition of new items or allocation of previously identified items to specific meeting dates of the commission.

BACKGROUND INFORMATION

3. The general terms of reference of the scrutiny commissions are set out in the council's constitution (overview and scrutiny procedure rules - paragraph 5). The constitution states that:

Within their terms of reference, all scrutiny committees/commissions will:

- a) review and scrutinise decisions made or actions taken in connection with the discharge of any of the council's functions
- b) review and scrutinise the decisions made by and performance of the cabinet and council officers both in relation to individual decisions and over time in areas covered by its terms of reference
- c) review and scrutinise the performance of the council in relation to its policy objectives, performance targets and/or particular service areas
- d) question members of the cabinet and officers about their decisions and performance, whether generally in comparison with service plans and targets over a period of time, or in relation to particular decisions, initiatives or projects and about their views on issues and proposals affecting the area

- e) assist council assembly and the cabinet in the development of its budget and policy framework by in-depth analysis of policy issues
 - f) make reports and recommendations to the cabinet and or council assembly arising from the outcome of the scrutiny process
 - g) consider any matter affecting the area or its inhabitants
 - h) liaise with other external organisations operating in the area, whether national, regional or local, to ensure that the interests of local people are enhanced by collaborative working
 - i) review and scrutinise the performance of other public bodies in the area and invite reports from them by requesting them to address the scrutiny committee and local people about their activities and performance
 - j) conduct research and consultation on the analysis of policy issues and possible options
 - k) question and gather evidence from any other person (with their consent)
 - l) consider and implement mechanisms to encourage and enhance community participation in the scrutiny process and in the development of policy options
 - m) conclude inquiries promptly and normally within six months
4. The work programme document lists those items which have been or are to be considered in line with the commission's terms of reference.

KEY ISSUES FOR CONSIDERATION

- 5. Set out in Appendix 1 (Work Programme) are the issues the Health & Social Care Scrutiny Commission is considering in 2024- 25.
- 6. The work programme is a standing item on the Health & Social Care Scrutiny Commission agenda and enables the commission to consider, monitor and plan issues for consideration at each meeting.

BACKGROUND DOCUMENTS

Background Papers	Held At	Contact
Health & Social Care Scrutiny Commission agenda and minutes	Southwark Council Website	Julie Timbrell Project Manager
Link: https://moderngov.southwark.gov.uk/ieListMeetings.aspx?Committeeld=518		

APPENDICES

No.	Title
Appendix 1	Work Plan 2025-26
Appendix A	Review: Adult Safeguarding – how can this be implemented to better protect vulnerable adults, carers and paid staff?

AUDIT TRAIL

Lead Officer	Everton Roberts, Head of Scrutiny		
Report Author	Julie Timbrell, Project Manager, Scrutiny.		
Version	Final		
Dated	26 January 2026		
Key Decision?	No		
CONSULTATION WITH OTHER OFFICERS / DIRECTORATES / CABINET MEMBER			
Officer Title		Comments Sought	Comments Included
Director of Law and Governance		No	No
Strategic Director of Finance and Governance		No	No
Cabinet Member		No	No
Date final report sent to Scrutiny Team			26 January 2026

Health and Social Care Scrutiny Commission 2025/26

Reviews

1. Adult Safeguarding – how can this be better implemented to protect vulnerable adults, carers and paid staff?
2. Cancer prevention and early diagnosis (mini review)

Topics

Damp and mould (continue 2024/25)

Follow up and new items 2025/26

- Blue Badge – update on progress following an item last administrative year
- Care Nursing Care Home model delivery cabinet response and tracking delivery (including looking at Nursing Home Space standards)
- FGM update on work with adult survivors
- Menopause
- Children's respite care and cost impact of the ending the provision at Orient Street
- GP appointments (with reference to work Partnership Southwark are doing to improve access to timely appointments)
- Improving access to toilets – update on previous scrutiny review
- Overcrowding and the impact on the mental health of children (with reference to Partnership Southwark work neighbourhood work with complex children)
- TFL :a) explore an earlier than 9am Freedom bus pass starting time (see if older peoples organisations and groups such as Age UK / National Pensioners Convention / Southwark Pensioners Centre/ SPAG have a view or ongoing campaigns)
b) driver behaviour (eg allowing people to sit down and embark safely) .

Partnership Southwark / South East London Integrated Care Board (SELICB) suggested items

Update on government reform of the ICB

Update on local priorities:

Frailty

Mental health and complex needs of children with reference to

- Neurodivergence (ADHD and autism)
- Neighbourhood work with children with complex needs (see above item on overcrowding)

GP Appointments – report back on engagement with local practices to improve access to timely appointments , with a focus on ensuring people who are not digital natives or have communication difficulties have alternative and easily accessible methods to book appointments (see above item on GP appointments)

Standing items

Interview with the Independent Chair of the Southwark Safeguarding Adults Board (SSAB). The Safeguarding Adults Board is a multi-agency partnership which has statutory functions under the Care Act 2014. The main role of Southwark Safeguarding Adults Board (SSAB) is to ensure that local safeguarding arrangements work effectively so that adults at risk due to health needs, social care needs or disabilities are able to live their lives free of abuse or neglect.

Interview Cabinet member/s : Cabinet Member for Health and Well-being

Follow up 2026/27 tbc

Pain management clinic – with reference to good practice community model in Lambeth

Health and Social Care Scrutiny Commission		
	Date	
1	Wednesday 2 July	• Children's respite care and cost impact of the ending the provision at Orient Street. • Cancer prevention • Safeguarding review – recap

		• Nursing care home delivery scrutiny review report • Workplan
2	Monday 16 October	• Headline on cancer prevention and early diagnosis • Nursing care home delivery – cabinet response • Update on Nursing Care Home delivery : officer briefing on engagement with market, cabinet report • Nursing Care Home Space Standards
	Pre meet w/b 24 Nov – Tuesday 25 all day or Wednesday 26 am	•
3	Monday 1 December	• Blue Badge – update on progress following an item last administrative year • Healthwatch Annual report (to note) • Hoarding officer report • Final scrutiny review report on cancer prevention and early diagnosis
4	Tuesday 27 January	Menopause covering: I. Presentation with a medical specialist II. discussion on improving local practice III. Review and discussion of council policies • Nursing Care Home Space Standards (Stirling Uni invited to provide present and officers to comment on planning & policy, if timely) • Improving access to toilets – update on previous scrutiny review
5	Monday 2 March	Mayor of London / TFL / London Councils :a) explore an earlier than 9am Freedom bus pass starting time b) driver behaviour (eg allowing people to sit down and embark safely) .

		c) London wide work on Blue Badge scheme Invite Age UK / National Pensioners Convention / Southwark Pensioners Centre/ SPAG to contribute to above Interview Cabinet Member for Health and Well-being GP Appointments – report back on engagement with local practices to improve access to timely appointments , with a focus on ensuring people who are not digital natives or have communication difficulties have alternative and easily accessible methods to book appointments Cancer review – final report Safeguarding scrutiny review headline report
	Middle of end of March meeting tbc	FGM covering I. prevention work to prevent girls coming to harm II. work with adult women on recognising and healing trauma Interview with the Safeguarding Board Independent Chair Safeguarding scrutiny review report

Scrutiny review scoping proposal

1 What is the review?

Adult Safeguarding – how can this be more consistently implemented to better protect and assist vulnerable adults, families, carers and paid staff?

The review is being conducted as members believe there is sometimes ambiguity, or different interpretations, over how Safeguarding is implemented for vulnerable adults and this can create difficulties for the people concerned: adults, staff, families, and carers.

These are some of the consequences inconsistent or poor quality Safeguarding approaches, including false accusations of abuse or neglect:

- Staff leaving the sector
- Staff staying but being resentful and demoralised (in the context of there already being a problem with recruitment and retention)
- In the case of family carers, them needing support and solutions but instead getting the opposite i.e criticism, leading to possible disengagement with services

2 What outcomes could realistically be achieved? Which agency does the review seek to influence?

Goals:

- To make things clearer for staff so that they are not accused of abuse or neglect when it is not abuse or neglect, so as not to put people off working in the sector
- Introduce checks and balances to prevent vexatious accusations
- Make the sure there is good systems in place for people to raise concerns / whistleblowing to report issues and ensure this is more transparent and accessible
- Improved guidelines for implementation of tricky safeguarding decisions

The review is aimed at improving outcomes for :

- Council safeguarding leads , social workers and commissioners
- Paid staff
- Care providers
- Vulnerable Adults
- Carers
- Family and friends of vulnerable adults

- 3 When should the review be carried out/completed? i.e. does the review need to take place before/after a certain time?**

Completed by 2024

- 4 What format would suit this review? (eg full investigation, q&a with executive member/partners, public meeting, one-off session)**

Full investigation.

- 5 What are some of the key issues that you would like the review to look at?**

Would it be beneficial to:

- To make better use in Adult Safeguarding of PIPOT (Persons in a Position of Trust) and replicate the LADO process – used in safeguarding children .
- promote undercover boss type work experience for senior managers to gain a better understanding of the work of care workers
- Recommend that social workers spend a week as a front line care worker (for example) as part of their training?
- SCIE training for local care home staff?

Conduct case studies and examine examples of where things are unclear:

- Some consider turning people every two hours during the night is necessary in order to prevent pressure sores, others consider this to be abuse. <https://hellocare.com.au/two-hourly-repositioning-prevent-bedsore-abuse-study/>
- Some staff are told that it is abuse to wake care home residents up, but sometimes staff are then told to do this
- Is it abuse or neglect to leave someone in bed all day?
- Call bells in care homes - disconnection considered to be abuse but there are cases where it could be necessary
- When looking after someone at home, families are often told that they should not lock the front door, but they do because they want to keep their relative with dementia safe. How can the approach of experienced practitioners be championed ? (see case study SLAM nurse)

6 Who would you like to receive evidence and advice from during the review?

- A. Hourglass (elder abuse charity)
- B. SCIE (Social Care Institute for Excellence)
- C. Chair of the Southwark Safeguarding Adults Board
- D. Officers from adult safeguarding department
- E. Managers of a local homes attend meeting to discuss i) Safeguarding ii) Disciplinary policy , with a view to discussing how investigations are carried out , and how to best balance fairness and valuing workers with the need to safeguard residents

[Agincare](#)

Greenhive Care Home (Peckham)
 Waterside Care Home (Peckham)
 Rose Court Care Home (Rotherhithe)
 Bluegrove House Care Home (Bermondsey)

[Country Court](#)

Camberwell Lodge Care Nursing Home

[HC One](#)

Tower Bridge Care Home

[Mission Care](#)

The Elms Residential Care Home

- F. Unions – to consider how investigations are conducted
- G. Care home resident (case study)
- H. SLAM dementia nurse (case study)
- I. Carer / former carers (case study)

Workshop / structured interviews addressing two themes:

- How are safeguarding investigations into allegations about workers being conducted and how can the right balance be found between being fair and valuing staff, whilst safeguarding vulnerable adults
- How to best reach consensus / balance safeguarding and autonomy over definitions e.g. people with dementia leaving home and turning people in the night

7 Any suggestions for background information? Are you aware of any best practice on this topic?

London Safeguarding Policy and Protocol

8 What approaches could be useful for gathering evidence? What can be done outside committee meetings?

e.g. verbal or written submissions, site visits, mystery-shopping, service observation, meeting with stakeholders, survey, consultation event

Interviews with organizations with expertise in this area.

Case studies – through a workshop.

Health & Social Care Scrutiny Commission

MUNICIPAL YEAR 2025-26

AGENDA DISTRIBUTION LIST (OPEN)

NOTE: Original held by Scrutiny Team; all amendments/queries to Julie.Timbrell@southwark.gov.uk

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